- *Web API applications*—Web API applications are similar to minimal API apps, in that they are typically consumed by SPAs and mobile apps. Web API apps provide additional functionality compared to minimal APIs, at the expense of some performance and convenience.

We'll look at each of these application types in this book, but in part 1 we focus on minimal APIs, so in section 3.2.1 we start by looking at the simplest ASP.NET Core app you can create.

3.2.1 Using a template to get started

In this section you'll use a template to create your first ASP.NET Core minimal API application. Using a template can get you up and running with an application quickly, automatically configuring many of the fundamental pieces. Both Visual Studio and the .NET CLI come with standard templates for building web applications, console applications, and class libraries.

TIP In .NET, a *project* is a unit of deployment, which will be compiled into a .dll file or an executable, for example. Each separate app is a separate project. Multiple projects can be built and developed at the same time in a *solution*.

To create your first web application, open Visual Studio, and perform the following steps:

1. Choose **Create a New Project** from the splash screen, or choose **File > New > Project** from the main Visual Studio screen.